

Israel Asefa

Backend Java Developer (Spring Boot / Distributed Systems)
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
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Portfolio: <https://israel-portfolio-henna.vercel.app/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Java developer with 4+ years of experience building and supporting production backend systems using Java and Spring Boot. Strong focus on REST APIs, databases, asynchronous messaging, and long-running services. Experience spans commercial platforms and self-directed systems work involving distributed workflows, payments, and infrastructure orchestration.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Java (8, 11, 17, 21)
- Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA
- Python
- REST API Design and Implementation
- Microservices Architecture
- PostgreSQL, MySQL
- MongoDB
- Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ
- Stripe Payments Integration
- Unit & Integration Testing (JUnit, Mockito)
- Git, CI/CD Pipelines
- Docker, Containerized Deployments
- Cloud Fundamentals (AWS, Azure)
- Agile / Scrum, Distributed Teams

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer — Backend (Java / Spring Boot)

NiteShift Systems — Remote
Feb 2023 – Present

- Designed and developed Spring Boot backend services for a commercial music streaming platform (JukeBox)
- Implemented REST APIs for authentication, user accounts, subscriptions, content access, and internal workflows
- Integrated Stripe for subscription billing and one-time purchases, including webhook handling
- Enforced backend-driven access control tied to subscription and payment state
- Designed and maintained PostgreSQL schemas for users, subscriptions, payments, and content metadata
- Used MongoDB for document-oriented data where relational modeling was not suitable
- Implemented analytics and event tracking for playback and access behavior
- Wrote unit and integration tests using JUnit and Mockito
- Fixed production bugs and supported live backend services
- Worked with Docker-based deployments and CI/CD pipelines
- Collaborated with distributed teams using Git and Scrum-based processes

Software Engineer — Backend (Java)

ETTA Solutions — Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Jun 2023 – Sep 2024

- Designed and maintained Spring Boot backend services for enterprise payment systems
- Built Tender Management and Internal Transfer tools, reducing manual processing and operational friction
- Developed ERCA-compliant document verification microservices using hashing and validation workflows
- Integrated Mastercard and digital wallet payment processing into an internally developed POS system
- Implemented backend services for SMS notifications and wallet-based transaction flows
- Designed and maintained PostgreSQL schemas for multi-tenant enterprise systems
- Implemented backend change tracking for product and pricing updates in the POS system
- Fixed production issues and supported live systems under regulatory and business constraints

Software Engineer

Ahaz Software Solutions – Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Feb 2021 – Dec 2022

- Built and maintained Spring Boot backend services for an HRMS platform used for payroll, attendance, and employee management
- Designed and implemented REST APIs supporting core HR workflows and internal integrations
- Designed and optimized relational database schemas for employee, payroll, and attendance data
- Implemented backend logic for payroll calculations and attendance processing
- Integrated biometric attendance devices using Python to support secure and automated time tracking
- Built backend workflows to process, validate, and persist device-generated data

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Spectrum – Event-Driven Deployment Orchestration System

Founder / Sole Engineer

2025 – Present

- Designed and implemented an internal control-plane system to manage deployments without manual SSH
- Built a Spring Boot control plane to manage users, hosts, instances, and persistent system state
- Built a Python/FastAPI orchestrator responsible for executing infrastructure tasks asynchronously
- Designed Kafka-based messaging workflows for instance creation, job execution, and status reporting
- Modeled explicit job lifecycles (requested, running, completed, failed) and persisted state reliably
- Automated container provisioning, configuration generation, port allocation, and database setup
- Enforced strict separation between control intent and execution logic
- Designed idempotent workflows and handled partial failures in asynchronous execution

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

HiLCoE School of Computer Science

2018 – 2022